



NEWS & PRODUCTION

STYLE GUIDE

2006
EDITION

STYLE GUIDE



KYTV, Inc.
999 W. Sunshine
Springfield, MO 65807
(417) 268-3000

PREFACE

This style guide accompanies all “on air” graphics for News and Production at KY3 NEWS. This style guide insures a consistent presentation of KY3 NEWS. You should become familiar with techniques applied at KY3 NEWS. Use the Style Guide as a guide when producing anything for air on KY3 NEWS.

A style guide establishes guidelines for an organization about style choices pertaining to “on air graphics.” It presents information about formatting and grammatical choices.

Designed as user friendly, this style guide explains information at KY3 NEWS. If still unclear about information, please ask questions for further explanations.

Please read through this guide to fully understand basic principles of the KY3 NEWS style.

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GRAMMAR AND STRUCTURE

ABBREVIATIONS

Usage, not logic, determines whether capitalization occurs in an abbreviation. Capitalization of some abbreviations changes the meaning of the abbreviation:

- ➔ e.g. atm = atmosphere
- ➔ e.g. ATM = Automatic Teller Machine

Capitalized abbreviations appear better on-screen, but know the meaning of the word before capitalizing.

Try not to abbreviate unless absolutely necessary. Otherwise, use the following titles for KY3 NEWS:

Civil Titles					
Associate	ASSOC.	Assistant	ASST.	Attorney	ATTY.
Director	DIR.	Engineer	ENG.	Governor	GOV.
Representative	REP.	Senator	SEN.		
Company Titles					
Chairman	CHAIR.	Commerce	COMM.	Company	CO.
Department	DEPT.	Division	DIV.	Government	GOVT.
Headquarters	HDQTRS.	Manager	MGR.	University	UNIV.
Directions					
Avenue	AVE.	County	CO.	Development	DEV.
Drive	DR.	Expressway	EXPWY.	Farm Road	FR.
Freeway	FRWY.	Highway	HWY.	Mount	MT.
Mountain	MTN.	Parkway	PKWY.	Springfield	SPFLD.
State	ST.	Street	ST.		
Military Titles					
Admiral	ADM.	Colonel	COL.	Captain	CPT.
Commissioner	COMM.	Corporal	CPL.	General	GEN.
Lieutenant	LT.	Major	MAG.	Private	PVT.
Sergeant	SGT.	Staff Sergeant	SSGT.		
Social Titles					
Doctor	DR.	Judge	Do not Abbreviate	Junior	JR.
Professor	PROF.	Reverend	REV.	Superintendent	SUPT.
Senior	SR.				

To abbreviate United States of America write as U.S.A., U.S., or USA. Please do not write as US.

All Courtesy Titles and Middle Initials require periods.

- ➔ *e.g.* MR., MRS., MS.
- ➔ *e.g.* DR., SEN., REP., SGT.
- ➔ *e.g.* John A. Doe, Jane C. Doe

ACRONYMS

An acronym is an abbreviation for a longer word or phrase, such as:

- ➔ *e.g.* NBC, NFL, NAACP, or NAFTA

Acronyms tend to become lowercase with frequent use:

- ➔ *e.g.* WASP / wasp or SCUBA / scuba

Do not assume viewers know acronyms as well as News personnel do.

CAPITALIZATION

Capitalization occurs in all Titles for KY3 NEWS and on bottom line of supers.

- ➔ *e.g.* TITLES OF FULL SCREENS

LISTS

When using parallel ideas or clear sequences of items, a list reveals the structure more quickly. Lists should match in capitalization, punctuation, font, spacing, signals such as numbering and bullets, and phrases or complete sentences.

If an item in a list extends into the next line, indent the second and subsequent lines. KY3 NEWS distinguishes lists by offsetting with white arrows on blue background or blue / white arrows on a gold background. You may also use bullets in place of arrows.

NUMBERS

Write numbers as a word (one) or as a figure (1). Use figures for all quantifiable units of measure no matter how small. Readers may comprehend and calculate information better with figures. Set decimal fractions of less than 1.0 with an initial zero (0.25, 0.50, 0.75). Spell out the number when lower than 10.

Always spell out "News at Five / Six / Ten" for all news font.

AGES

When Age appears as an adjective, hyphenate. When age appears as a noun, do not hyphenate.

- ➔ *e.g. Noun form* Susie is 15 years old.
- ➔ *e.g. Adjective form* A 15-year-old girl fell into a well.

PHONE NUMBERS

When presenting a phone number always use the area code. Present the area code in parenthesis whether on a FULLSCREEN or LOWER THIRD SUPER.

- ➔ *e.g.* (417) 268-3000
- ➔ *e.g.* 1-800-268-3000

POSTAL CODES

For graphic purposes always use the Postal Codes without periods for the 50 states, District of Columbia, and Puerto Rico.

Alabama	AL	Alaska	AK	Arizona	AZ
Arkansas	AR	California	CA	Colorado	CO
Connecticut	CT	Delaware	DE	District of Columbia	DC
Florida	FL	Georgia	GA	Hawaii	HI
Idaho	ID	Illinois	IL	Indiana	IN
Iowa	IA	Kansas	KS	Kentucky	KY
Louisiana	LA	Maine	ME	Maryland	MD
Massachusetts	MA	Michigan	MI	Minnesota	MN
Mississippi	MS	Missouri	MO	Montana	MT
Nebraska	NE	Nevada	NV	New Hampshire	NH
New Jersey	NJ	New Mexico	NM	New York	NY
North Carolina	NC	North Dakota	ND	Ohio	OH
Oklahoma	OK	Oregon	OR	Pennsylvania	PA
Puerto Rico	PR	Rhode Island	RI	South Carolina	SC
South Dakota	SD	Tennessee	TN	Texas	TX
Utah	UT	Vermont	VT	Virginia	VA
Washington	WA	West Virginia	WV	Wisconsin	WI
Wyoming	WY				

PUNCTUATION

APOSTROPHES

Use apostrophes only before an "s" when possessive.

- ➔ Do not use on dates like 1990s or 90s.
- ➔ Do not use on words like CDs etc.

COLONS

A colon introduces an element or a series of elements and may replace the period. It must follow a complete sentence.

Between independent clauses, it functions much like a semicolon, though emphasizes sequences more.

COMMAS

Commas indicate the smallest break in a sentence. It denotes a slight pause. Use the comma after each item in a series of three or more items with a conjunction.

→ *e.g.* Lunch consisted of a sandwich, soup, and salad.

Use between adjectives that modify the noun, but not after the final adjective.

→ *e.g.* The large, dead, oak tree fell down.

Use after introductory statements.

→ *e.g.* First, you will learn the appropriate use of commas.

→ *e.g.* However, using a comma when not needed is a comma splice.

HYPHENS

The hyphen joins two or more words together to form a compound adjective. The combined words function as a unit.

→ *e.g.* first-level headings

Do not use hyphens between words written better as one word.

→ *e.g.* water-fowl for waterfowl.

SEMICOLONS

A semicolon replaces the comma and conjunction or a period. Common usage occurs between two independent clauses not joined by a conjunction.

Do not use conjunctions with the semicolon.

→ *e.g.* John drove to the store; he bought groceries.

SENTENCE STRUCTURE

Sentence structure helps readers interpret meaning of sentences. Sentences have two main parts: subjects and predicates. The subject states the topic of the sentence, while the predicate comments about the subject.

The subject identifies the agent or recipient of the action in a sentence. The simple subject lacks modifiers. Modifiers consist of articles like "the" and other adjectives.

The predicate explains what the subject does or what happens to the subject. It makes a statement or asks a question about the subject.

The predicate always includes a verb. The simple predicate includes the verb or verb phrase.

Sentence structure also involves adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, conjunctive adverbs, and verbals:

Adjectives	Modify noun(s) or pronoun(s)
Adverbs	Modify verb(s), adjective(s), or other adverb(s)
Conjunctions	Join words, phrases, or clauses
Conjunctive Adverbs	Modify entire clause
Prepositions	Link the object to another word in the sentence
Pronouns	Substitutes for noun(s)
Verbals	Convert verbs into words that function as nouns or adjectives

TITLES

Always begin FULLSCREEN information with a title. All titles appear on the gold bar at top of blue background:



Titles use **Futura Hv BT**, except Sports—which uses **Futura Bklt BT**. Titles appear in ALL CAPS and white font.

GRAPHICS

ANIMATED FRANCHISE OPENS

KY3 News uses animated franchise opens as the most regularly scheduled franchise. These should air as Voice Over effect to the taped report.

The background for a franchise bug consists of two blue lines separated by a thin yellow line:



BUGS

Bugs allow audience members to recognize what station they are watching. Bugs also act as a constant promotion for KY3 News.

Both the KY3 Crystal Bug and Color Bug appear at the bottom left of the screen. Please do not show both bugs at the same time.

The crystal bug consists of the KY3 NEWS logo on a transparent background; the letters appear white on screen:



The color bug consists of the KY3 NEWS logo on a transparent background; the letters appear yellow on screen:



Seven Franchise Bugs appear on screen at all times during packages:

- ➔ Contact KY3
- ➔ Decision (Year) voiceovers
- ➔ Healthwatch

- ➔ Healthwatch Block (5 pm)
- ➔ Hollywood Happenings
- ➔ Making News
- ➔ Specialty Bugs (Target: Iraq, etc.)

Four Franchise Bugs appear five seconds off the top and then dissolve out during packages:

- ➔ Better Living
- ➔ Front Row at Five
- ➔ Hi-Tech Talks
- ➔ Money Talks

Some titles do not receive bugs at all:

- ➔ AdWatch Packages
- ➔ Decision (Year) Packages
- ➔ Around America / Region / World Packages

Note that Around America / Region / World only receives a bug:

- ➔ During series of voiceovers
- ➔ When scripted

Only remove if Franchise Bug interferes with video.

The director and/or producer will determine any other circumstances that arise, until establishing a definite policy.

BUMPERS

Do not use generic slug lines like FAMILY HEALTHWATCH, etc. KY3 NEWS does not use slugs for bumpers. Newscasts produced for Noon, five, six, and ten do use animation for bumpers. Ozarks Today does not use animation.

COLOR

Colors enhance text and appeal to readers. For example, viewers' eyes focus better on dark text, because dark text stands out on a light background.

The INFINIT and SWITCHER are capable of producing many different colors. However, these colors may not help communicate information more clearly on screen.

Use white and black from the KY3 INFINIT palette for all news fonts.

DOCUMENT DESIGN

ALIGNMENT

The four basic types of alignment include left, right, justified, and centered:

- ➔ Left-alignment occurs when text aligns on the left with a ragged right edge.
- ➔ Right-alignment occurs when text aligns on the right with a ragged left edge.
- ➔ Justified-alignment occurs when text aligns equally on both right and left edges.
- ➔ Center-alignment occurs when text aligns in the middle with both ragged left and right edges.

Text appearing in KY3 NEWS documents uses left-alignment except for the Morning News. Morning News uses centered background for Time and Temp bugs, this allows FULLSCREENS to look the best.

FULL SCREENS BACKGROUNDS

Use the rolling blue background with Partial A Bar on the left for all News Backgrounds:



Pre-produced backgrounds exist for FRANCHISES, WEATHER, and SPORTS.

Furthermore, create custom backgrounds by screening a graphic element or video into the blue part. Never cover the entire screen with an image.

If unsure of what image to use, always use a clean background. Try and use a rolling background whenever possible.

The FULLSCREEN generic background should always work.

OFFSETS

Offsets have graphic elements, ad lines, and bullet points. Customize Offsets for a specific story. Create these with original elements from the CHYRON, adding desired graphics via the DME and super information via the CHYRON. This process builds a generic still library.

Build new stills on a daily or as needed basis.

Some Offsets may require adding CHYRON bullets. Bullets always appear live.

SUPERS

Supers represent superimposition, the simultaneous showing of two full pictures on the same screen. Supers come in and go out as cuts and appear with first video as scripted.

Supers appear at the bottom of the screen, also known as lower third:



Please keep Supers as short as possible and leave up as long as possible.

Website and Phone Number Supers stay up for entire duration of voice over. You may also leave Supers up for entire duration of any voiceover when scripted for use. The standard duration for all other Supers remains at five to seven seconds, unless requiring a shorter duration.

COURTESY / TIME REFERENCES / FILE

Use Courtesy / Time References / File Supers for Networks and Production Companies. These appear in the last field of the super.

- ➔ "Men In Black"
Universal Pictures
KOLR-CBS (INFINIT operators please use the one line locator.)

Use Time References over File whenever possible.

- ➔ APRIL 19, 1995

If current for the year, do not use the year:

- ➔ *e.g. (Current Year is 2006)* Do not use April 1, 2006
- ➔ *e.g. (Current Year is 2006)* Use April 1

Use File Pictures as a last resort.

- ➔ 999. W. Sunshine / Springfield / File Pictures
BRANSON, MO / FILE PICTURES
FILE PICTURES

Please do not use the term "File Pictures" when a date exists.

LOCATOR SUPERS

Locator Supers indicate a location for a person or place. Use one of the four styles for Locator Supers. These should appear on two lines with the address or landmark on top; city or county and state on bottom. If unavailable specific location, use a one line locator.

Abbreviate directions, streets, drives, roads, and avenues that appear in locators. Spell out "COUNTY" whenever possible, if unavailable use CO. Use States on all city or county locators, except Springfield. Use postal codes for all states.

- ➔ Two line locators appear:
1403 E. Hart ST.
SPRINGFIELD

or
City Hall
SPRINGFIELD
- ➔ Two line live locators appear:
LIVE
1403 E. Hart ST.
SPRINGFIELD

or
LIVE
City Hall
SPRINGFIELD
- ➔ One line locators appear:
GREENE COUNTY, MO
- ➔ Never use a one line live locator

NAME SUPERS

Name Supers appear on two lines with the name of person on the top and person's title on the bottom.

- ➔ Jane Smith
ALIEN'S MOTHER

Ranks for military, police, and fire appear on the top line abbreviated with the name. Also, Titles of State and USA lawmakers appear on the top line abbreviated with the name.

- ➔ *e.g.* GOV. Matt Blunt
(R) MISSOURI

Reserve DR. for medical doctors and Ph.D. for people with a doctorate.

PROMO SUPERS

Promo Supers, like "Tonight at Five," should stay up for the duration of any voiceover when scripted for use (during a newscast). Please do not confuse Promo Supers with Promo's produced after newscasts.

TEMPLATE

The template, a type of format page, allows you to create a document using previously designed pages. Therefore, you do not have to create FULLSCREENS using a blank or erased page. The template provides a large library of formatted pages. Templates also provide typographic size and style consistency.

If something does not fit an existing template, first figure out why it does not--maybe it should. Then make small alterations to an existing format to accommodate new information.

Let a supervisor know if the item still does not fit the template. The supervisor will know to create a new page for use on everyone's show.

TIME

Time indicates a point in the day, such as morning, noon, or evening. To show time indicate the hour and minute followed by the lowercase pm or am for ONAIR:

- ➔ *e.g.* 6:00am
- ➔ *e.g.* 6:00pm

Never remove the KY3 clock during Ozarks Today or during LIVE am Cut-Ins.

TYPEFACE

Typeface, also known as font, is the type design with distinguishing character shapes and a name like Times New Roman or Arial.

For all news fonts use **Futura XBlkCn BT**, **Futura HvlIt BT**, or **Futura BldIt BT**. CHYRON operators have created these as machine fonts in various sizes.

VIDEO SCOOPS

Scoops appear onscreen as half in text and the other half in video.

To produce Video Scoops only use Snapshot 25 (KM SCOO), on either ME-1 or ME-2. Use a rolling blue background for the blue portion of the scoop. Set the Snapshot at 85% density, to see the video behind the blue. Do not compress or slide the video over. Override this rule when the video involves a person.

Make sure to turn on the KY3 Crystal Bug when making scoops. The CG format does not include a lower third bug.

Never produce Video Scoops live, unless absolutely necessary.

DIRECTIONS

HAND SIGNALS

Hand Signals help signal amount of time remaining. KY3 NEWS uses a hand signal to identify 30 seconds, one minute, five minutes, and fifteen minutes.

To represent 30 seconds use your right hand to make a backward C:



To represent fifteen seconds make your hand into a fist.



For CUT-INS, PROMOS, or WEATHER count down from five. To count down indicate five fingers, four fingers, three fingers, two fingers, and one finger.

To indicate that person is on camera, camera operator will point at the person.

To indicate a wrap, use one finger pointing up and twirl hand in a clockwise pattern.

To cue talent to stop talking, use right hand by placing just below the chin and move it to the right or continue wrapping.

MAPS

Maps identify a specific location for viewers. Maps appearing on KY3 NEWS use red dots or counties highlighted in yellow.

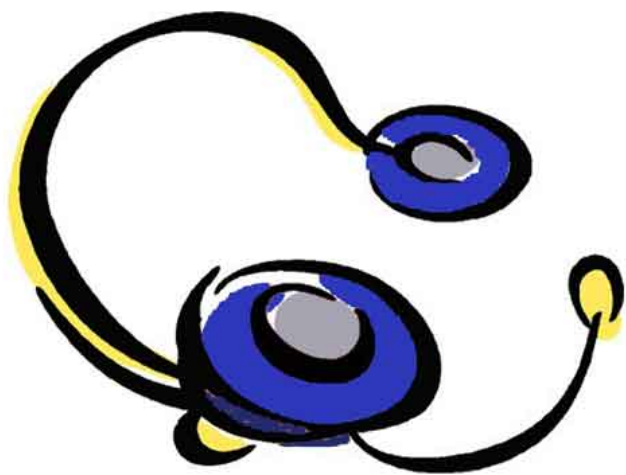
Producers now create and e-mail all maps for use during newscasts.

Use red dots as locator points on all maps:



When focusing on a specific county or counties, highlight county(ies) in yellow:





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